“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 10

Śrī Caitanya Accepts *Prasāda

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who bestows grace on His devotees and is pleased with whatever a devotee offers Him with faith.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 The next year all the devotees set out in great joy for Nīlācala to see the Lord.

4 Foremost of all was Advaitācārya Gosāñi; with him came Ācāryaratna, Ācāryanidhi, Śrīvāsa and other blessed devotees.

5 Although the Lord had ordered Him to remain in Gauḍa, Nityānanda set out out of love to see Him.

6 This is the sign of *anurāga* (deep, spontaneous love): it does not heed rules (*vidhi*). For the sake of His company it breaks His order.

7 So it was in the *rāsa* dance: He told the *gopīs* to go home, but they broke His order and stayed with Him.

8 Whatever satisfaction Kṛṣṇa feels when His order is kept, when it is broken out of love He is nourished with joy a millionfold greater.

9–11 Vāsudeva Datta, Murāri Gupta, Gaṅgādāsa, Śrīmān Sena, Śrīmān Paṇḍita, Akiñcana Kṛṣṇadāsa, Murāri, Garuḍa Paṇḍita, Buddhimanta Khān, Sañjaya Puruṣottama, Bhagavān Paṇḍita, Śuklāmbara, Nṛsiṁhānanda and all the others set out. Their names cannot all be written down.

12 The people of Kulīnagrāma and the residents of Khaṇḍa came and joined them, and Śivānanda Sena came, bringing everyone along.

13 Rāghava Paṇḍita set out with his *jhālis* (hampers), packed with all the things that Damayantī had prepared and given him.

14 There were many wonderful foods, offerings worthy of the Lord, which the Lord would partake of for a whole year.

15–16 There were mango *kāśandi* and the relishes called ginger and chili *kāśandi*, lime and ginger with mango buds, and other preparations; *āmsi*, *āma-khaṇḍa*, *tailāmra* (mango pickle in mustard oil) and *āma-sattā*; and dried *śuktā* (bitter greens), carefully ground into powder.

17 Do not look down on it because it is only *śuktā*: the joy found in *śuktā* is not found even in *pañcāmṛta*.

18 Mahāprabhu accepts the feeling (*bhāva-grāhī*); He accepts only the affection. So in *śuktā* leaves and *kāśandi* He found great joy.

19 Damayantī, in her affection, regarded the Lord as a human being (*manuṣya-buddhi*): “From heavy food, *āma* (indigestion) may sometimes form in His stomach.

20 If He eats *śuktā*, that *āma* will be cured.” Thinking of her affection, the Lord was delighted.

21 “A full-breasted woman would not cast off the garland, though it was soiled with water, because her beloved had strung it and placed it on her breast in the presence of her rivals; for virtues dwell in love, not in the thing itself.” (*Kirātārjunīya*)

22 She ground coriander and anise seeds into powder, cooked it in sugar syrup and shaped it into *nāḍus* (sweet balls).

23 *Nāḍus* of dry ginger and sugar, and others that cure *āma* and bile, she tied up separately in little cloth bags.

24 Dried *kul* berries (*koli-śuṇṭhi*), *kul* powder, *kul* with sugar — how many names shall I list? — and a hundred kinds of pickles (*ācāra*).

25 Coconut sweets and *gaṅgājali nāḍus* (white sweet balls) — she made every kind of sugar sweet that would keep a long time.

26 Long-lasting *kṣīrasāra* (thickened cream), *maṇḍā* and other milk sweets, *amṛta-karpūra* and many other kinds.

27 From *śālikācaṭi* paddy she made sun-dried (*ātapa*) flat rice and filled big bags of new cloth with it.

28 Some of the flat rice she made into *huḍum* (puffed rice) and fried it in ghee; then, adding camphor and other spices, she made *nāḍus* of it in sugar syrup.

29–30 She fried grains of *śāli* rice and ground them to powder, moistened the powder with ghee and cooked it with sugar syrup. Then, adding powdered camphor, black pepper, cloves, cardamom and *rasavāsa* (aromatic spice), she made most fragrant *nāḍus*.

31 Again, she fried *khai* (popped rice) of *śāli* paddy in ghee and made *ukhḍā* in sugar syrup, adding camphor and other spices.

32 She ground *phuṭkalāi* (fried peas) to powder and fried it in ghee, and with sugar syrup and camphor made *nāḍus* of it.

33 There were a thousand kinds of such foods, whose names I could not tell in this lifetime.

34 Rāghava gave the orders, and Damayantī carried them out. Both had deep affection and supreme devotion for the Lord.

35 She brought clay from the Gaṅgā, strained it through cloth, mixed in fragrant substances and made it into *pāṁc-kuḍi* (thin wafers).

36 She filled thin clay pots with sandalwood paste and other things, and packed everything else in little cloth bags.

37 She had *jhālis* made twice the size of ordinary ones, and had them all packed neatly.

38 She tied up the *jhālis* and carefully sealed them. Three porters carried them, taking turns.

39 I have briefly described these *jhālis*, which became famous as “Rāghava’s *jhālis*.”

40 Makaradhvaja Kara was the *munsib* (steward) of the *jhālis*; he guarded them vigilantly, as if they were his very life.

41 In this way all the Vaiṣṇavas came to Nīlācala. As providence would have it, that day was Jagannātha’s water pastime.

42 On the waters of Narendra Lake, Śrī Govinda boarded a boat and sported in the water with all the devotees.

43 At that time Mahāprabhu came joyfully to Narendra with His devotees to watch the water play.

44 At that very time all the devotees of Gauḍa met the Lord at Narendra.

45 The devotees came and fell at the Lord's feet, and the Lord raised them all and embraced them.

46 The whole Gauḍīya party sang *kīrtana*, and on meeting the Lord they wept with love.

47 Water sports, music, singing, dancing and *kīrtana* — a great tumult on the shore and play in the water.

48 The Gauḍīyas' *saṅkīrtana* and their weeping mingled, and the sound of that great tumult filled the universe.

49 The Lord entered the water with all the devotees and sported with them all in delight.

50 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described these water sports of the Lord at length in his *Caitanya-maṅgala* (the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*).

51 If I describe them here again, it will be repetition — useless writing that only makes my book longer.

52 After the water pastime Govinda returned to His abode, and the Lord went to the temple with His associates.

53 After seeing Jagannātha, He returned to His residence, had *prasāda* brought and fed the devotees.

54 For some time He talked with them all of Kṛṣṇa (*iṣṭa-goṣṭhī*), and then sent everyone to the lodgings each had occupied before.

55 Rāghava handed the *jhālis* over to Govinda, and they were kept in a corner of the dining room.

56 Govinda emptied the previous year's *jhālis* and took them to another room, keeping them there to be filled with provisions.

57 The next day Mahāprabhu went with His associates to see Jagannātha at His rising from bed.

58 There He began the *beḍā-saṅkīrtana* (the *kīrtana* around the temple), and seven parties began to sing.

59 In the seven parties seven persons danced: Advaita Ācārya and Prabhu Nityānanda,

60 Vakreśvara, Acyutānanda, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Satyarāja Khān and Narahari dāsa.

61 The Lord moved among the seven parties, and each one thought, "The Lord is in my party."

62 The tumult of the *saṅkīrtana* pierced the sky, and all the residents of Jagannātha's town came to see.

63 The king came with his retinue and watched from a distance, and all the queens watched from the upper storey of the palace.

64 In the ecstasy of the *kīrtana* the earth trembled. The people called out “Hari!” and there was a great tumult.

65 In this way He had the *kīrtana* performed for some time; then the Lord wished to dance Himself.

66 On seven sides the seven parties sang and played, and in the middle Gaura Rāya danced, absorbed in great love.

67 A line of an Oḍiyā song came to Mahāprabhu’s mind, and He told Svarūpa to sing it:

68 “Let my head be offered at the Jagamohana!”

69 To this line He danced, absorbed in His own feeling, and all the people around floated in the Lord’s love.

70 Raising His holy arms, the Lord called, “Say it! Say it!” and the people, floating in bliss, called out “Hari!”

71 The Lord fell and lost consciousness; He was no longer breathing. Then suddenly He rose with a roar.

72 His hair bristled thickly, like the thorns of a *śimula* tree. At times His body swelled; at times it grew thin.

73 From every pore came perspiration and blood, and His faltering voice uttered only “jaja,” “gaga,” “pari,” “mumu.”

74 Each of His teeth shook separately; they shook as if they would come loose and fall to the ground.

75 Moment by moment the Lord's blissful ecstasy grew. The third *prahara* of the day came, and still the dance did not end.

76 The ocean of bliss surged in everyone, and all the people forgot body, self and home.

77 Then Nityānanda Prabhu devised a means: one by one He stopped all the singers.

78 Only the principal parties went on singing with Svarūpa, softly.

79 When the tumult died down, the Lord regained some outer awareness. Then Nityānanda told Him how tired everyone was.

80 Knowing that the devotees were tired, He brought the *kīrtana* to an end, went with them all and bathed in the sea.

81 The Lord took *prasāda* with them all and then sent everyone off to rest.

82 He Himself lay down at the door of the Gambhīrā, and Govinda came to massage His feet.

83–84 It had always been a firm rule: when the Lord lay down after taking prasāda, Govinda would come and massage His feet, and only then go and eat the Lord's remnants.

85 That day the Lord lay down filling the whole doorway. Unable to go inside, Govinda made a request:

86 "Please move to one side and let me go in." The Lord said, "I have no strength to move My body."

87 Again and again Govinda asked Him to move aside, but the Lord said, “I cannot move My body.”

88 Govinda said, “I want to massage Your feet.” The Lord said, “Do it or not, as you like.”

89 Then Govinda spread his outer cloth (*bahirvāsa*) over Him, stepped over the Lord and went into the inner room.[1]

90 He massaged His feet and pressed His waist and back, and by that gentle rubbing the Lord’s weariness went away.

91 The Lord fell happily asleep while Govinda pressed His body, and after some two *daṇḍas* (about forty-eight minutes) the Lord woke.

92 Seeing Govinda, the Lord spoke angrily: “Why have you been sitting here so long today?

93 When I fell asleep, why didn’t you go to take prasāda?” Govinda said, “You lay in the doorway; there was no way to go.”

94 The Lord said, “Then how did you come inside? Why didn’t you go out the same way to take prasāda?”

95 Govinda said within himself, “Service is my rule. Let there be offense, or even going to hell.

96 For the sake of service I do not count even ten million offenses, but for my own sake I fear even the shadow of an offense.”

97 Thinking all this, Govinda remained silent and gave no answer to what the Lord had asked.

98 Every day, when the Lord slept, he would go to take prasāda; but that day, seeing the Lord so weary, he began to press His body.

99 And even to go there was no way. How could he go? To step over the Lord is a great offense.

100 All these are the subtle secrets of the scriptures of bhakti. Only by Śrī Caitanya's mercy does one know all these principles.

101 The Lord delights in revealing the virtues of His devotees; to reveal all this He played such a scene.

102 Thus I have briefly told of this dance in a circle (*parimuṇḍā-nṛtya*), which Śrī Caitanya's servants sing of even today.

103 In this way Mahāprabhu, with His own associates, washed and cleaned the Guṇḍicā temple.

104 As before, the Lord sang kīrtana and danced, and as before He took a meal in the garden as in a forest (*vanya-bhojana*).

105 As before, He danced in front of the chariot and saw the Herā-pañcamī festival.

106 All the devotees stayed for the four months of the rains and saw Janmāṣṭamī and the other festivals.

107 Earlier, when the devotees had come from Gauḍa, every one of them wished to feed the Lord something.

108 Each would bring some prasāda and give it to Govinda, saying, "See that the Gosāñi eats this without fail."

109 Some brought *peḍā*, some *nāḍu*, some cakes and sweet drinks — costly, fine prasāda of many kinds.[2]

110 Govinda would tell Him, “So-and-so has given this,” but the Lord would say, “Put it aside,” and would not eat.

111 As he kept putting things aside, one corner of the room filled up: food enough for a hundred people was stored there.

112 Everyone eagerly asked Govinda, “Did you have the Lord eat the prasāda I gave?”

113 Govinda put them off, telling each one something. Then one day he spoke to the Lord in despair:

114 “Advaita Ācārya and the other honored devotees carefully give me things to feed You.

115 You do not eat them, and they ask again and again. How long can I put them off? How shall I be delivered?”

116 The Lord said, “Those who have long lived with Me — why should they feel sorrow? Bring here whatever anyone has given.”[3]

117 Saying this, Mahāprabhu sat down to eat, and Govinda offered Him everything, naming each giver:

118 “This is the Ācārya’s *paiḍa*, and various cakes full of juice; this is *amṛta-guṭikā*, *maṇḍā*, and a jar of camphor.

119 These many kinds are from Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita: cakes, sweet drinks, *amṛta-maṇḍā* and sugar lotuses (*padma-cini*).

120 All these gifts are Ācāryaratna's, and these many kinds are Ācāryanidhi's.

121 These are from Vāsudeva Datta and Murāri Gupta, and these various kinds from Buddhimanta Khān.

122 Śrīmān Sena, Śrīmān Paṇḍita, Nandana Ācārya — please eat what they have given.

123 Look first at all these from Kulīnagrāma, and look at these, just as many, from the people of Khaṇḍa."

124 So, naming every one, Govinda set the things before the Lord, and the Lord, well pleased, ate them all.

125–126 Though the coconuts with their tops cut open, the *amṛta-guṭikās*, the drinks and all the rest were a month old, everything tasted almost fresh. Nothing was stale or tasteless — such was the Lord's grace.[4]

127 In a single *daṇḍa* the Lord ate food enough for a hundred people, and asked Govinda, "Is there anything more?"

128 Govinda said, "Only Rāghava's *jhālis* are left." The Lord said, "Let them stay today; I will look at them later."

129 Another day, when the Lord ate in seclusion, He opened Rāghava's *jhālis* and looked at everything.

130 He tasted a little of every item and, finding them delicious and fragrant, praised them highly.

131 The rest He kept in store for a whole year, and at mealtimes Svarūpa would take out a little and serve it.

132 Sometimes, at night too, Svarūpa would have Him partake of a little; for the Lord surely enjoys what a devotee gives with faith (*śraddhā*).

133 Thus Mahāprabhu passed the Cāturmāsya with His devotees in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa.

134 From time to time Advaita Ācārya and others would invite Him, cooking rice and various vegetable dishes at home:

135 hot peppery dishes and sweet-and-sour ones, ginger, salt, lime, milk, yogurt and sugar candy (*khaṇḍa-sāra*);

136 two or four kinds of greens, a broth of *śuktā*, eggplant with *nimba*, and fried *paṭola*;

137 fried *phula-baḍī* and mung dal soup — they cooked various dishes to suit the Lord's taste.

138 They would bring Jagannātha's prasāda to mix with these. Sometimes the Lord went alone, sometimes with His associates.

139 Ācāryaratna, Ācāryanidhi, Nandana, Rāghava, Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees who were brāhmaṇas —

140–141 these would invite Him in this way with great care. Vāsudeva, Gadādhara, Murāri Gupta, the people of Kulīnagrāma and of Khaṇḍa, and all the others would invite Him by bringing Jagannātha's prasāda.

142 Now hear the story of Śivānanda Sena's invitation. Śivānanda's eldest son was named Caitanya dāsa.

143 He brought him along to introduce him to the Lord, and when he had introduced him, the Lord asked his name.

144 Hearing the name Caitanya dāsa, Gaurarāya said, “What name have you given him? I cannot make it out.”

145 Sena said, “I gave him the name I knew.” Saying this, he invited Mahāprabhu.

146 He had costly prasāda of Jagannātha brought, and the Lord sat down to eat with the devotees.

147 Out of regard for Śivānanda the Lord ate, but His mind was not pleased by so heavy a meal.

148 Another day Caitanya dāsa invited Him, and, understanding the Lord’s desire, brought dishes to suit it:

149 yogurt, lime, ginger, *phula-baḍā* and salt. Seeing these things, the Lord was pleased at heart.

150 The Lord said, “This boy knows My mind. I am satisfied with his invitation.”

151 Saying this, He ate rice with yogurt, and made Caitanya dāsa the recipient of His remnants.

152 In this way four months passed in invitations, and some Vaiṣṇavas could not get a day.

153 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya had fixed days for feeding Him (*bhikṣā*).

154–155 Gopīnātha Ācārya, Jagadānanda, Kāśīśvara, Bhagavān, Rāmabhadra Ācārya, Śaṅkara and Vakreśvara would from time to time

invite Him to rice cooked at home. When others invited Him, the prasāda cost two *paṇas* of cowries.

156 At first the fixed sum had been four *paṇas* of cowries, but out of fear of Rāmacandra Purī they reduced the invitation.

157 After they had stayed four months, He bade farewell to the devotees of Gauḍa, and His companions of Nīlācala remained with Him.

158 Thus I have told of the invitations to the Lord's meals and how He relished the things His devotees gave.

159 Within it is the account of Rāghava's *jhālis*, and within it too the telling of the dance in a circle (*parimuṇḍā-nṛtya*).

160 Whoever hears the narrations of Śrī Caitanya with faith will surely attain love for Śrī Caitanya's feet.

161 To hear them is like nectar; they soothe the ears and the mind. Fortunate is he who relishes them.

162 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Bahirvāsa*, the outer cloth: the *Anubhāṣya* (heading to this verse) says that Govinda places his own *bahirvāsa* on the Lord's body and steps over Him. ↩
2. *Peḍā*, a sweet of thickened milk; the *Anubhāṣya* records the variant *paiḍa* (coconut, as in verse 118). ↩
3. *Ādivasyā*, "old residents": those who have long lived with the Lord (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: they have no cause for sorrow, for the delicacies were brought by those who have just come from Gauḍa). The *Anubhāṣya* heads

the verse “The Lord asks why the devotees are sorrowful” and records other senses given to the word: “unfortunate,” “foolish,” “fickle-minded,” “overeager” (*ā-dekhlā*, *kāṅlā*). ↩

4. *Mukutā nārikela*, coconuts with the top cut open (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩